

Somewhere in your house there's  
a dragon nobody else has ever  
heard of.

You made it up at nine o'clock at night, with one hand on a small back.  
You've told the story fifty times. You couldn't repeat it now if you tried.

The Stories I Made Up is a keepsake for the bedtime stories a parent invents:  
the recurring cast, the one that only works if you do the voice, the ones that  
were mostly a list of animals. One story to a spread, with a title line, the date  
you first told it, a box to tick every time it's asked for, and room for the  
listener to draw what the dragon really looks like.

Eight pages for the cast. Thirty-six stories. A place for the one they always  
asked for, the long way. A place for the stories that never got finished. A place  
for the listener's own stories, and, at the end, one written now for a night you  
might not be there.

Nobody else has ever heard these. That's what makes them theirs.

Write them down while you still remember how they  
go.

# THE STORIES I MADE UP

*Every story I ever told you, written down.*